JL COLLECTION

Premium Botanical Treatment Oil

FORMULA + SENSORY + POSITIONING DISCUSSION

Working objective: build a scalp-first treatment oil with a premium botanical story - but a light, fast-spreading, non-greasy finish.

Physical Meeting Deck

Draft for discussion - not a manufacturing formula



LIGHT FEEL

Treatment depth without the traditional heavy-oil experience.

What We Need to Decide in the Meeting

A practical discussion agenda for moving from ingredient list to a premium product brief.

01	**Formula identity**	Which botanicals are essential to the JL story - and which need regulatory review or replacement?
02	**Sensory target**	How light should it feel: pre-wash treatment, leave-in serum-oil, or a hybrid that can do both?
03	**Benchmark**	Do we benchmark Mielle Light for scalp treatment, or Olaplex/Gisou for ultra-light finishing feel?
04	**Claim territory**	Scalp nourishment + breakage/length retention + shine - without medical hair-regrowth claims.
05	**Validation plan**	Prototype rounds, stability, irritation/safety, packaging compatibility and consumer sensory testing.

Goal: agree a product brief - not final percentages

JL COLLECTION - Current Draft Ingredient System

The current list has a strong botanical story, but it contains both rich carrier oils and actives that require careful processing.

Scalp-Focused Botanicals

- Arnica montana
- Rosemary oil
- Jaborandi*
- Thuja*

Ayurvedic Hair Botanicals

- Amla
- Shikakai
- Reetha

Nourishing Carrier Oils

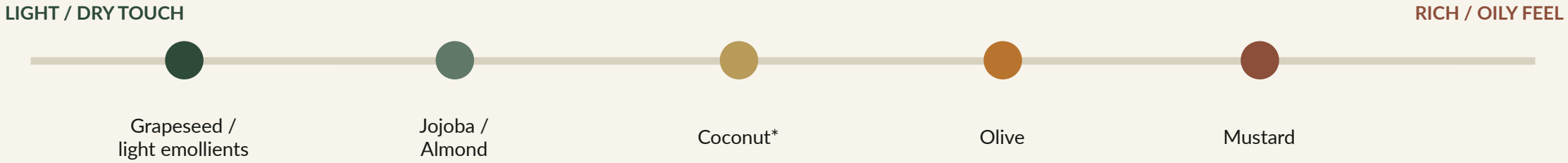
- Mustard oil
- Olive oil
- Almond oil
- Coconut oil

FORMULATION REALITY Shikakai, Reetha, Amla and Arnica are best handled as standardized/oil-compatible extracts or infusions in an anhydrous oil. Raw herb powders would undermine clarity, stability, dosing and a premium sensory finish.

** Jaborandi and Thuja require specific safety/regulatory review before final inclusion.*

Why the Current Oil List Could Feel Heavy

Mustard, olive, almond and coconut oils can create a rich treatment feel if they dominate the base. The sensory target needs a different architecture.



Recommended sensory brief

- Spreads quickly with 2-4 drops
- No sticky scalp film after massage
- Hair stays movable - not coated
- Low transfer to hands / pillow / clothing
- Soft satin shine, not wet/oily shine

What this means for the base

- Light carrier/emollient must lead the formula
- Heavy heritage oils become supporting ingredients
- Botanical story comes from concentrated extracts
- Essential-oil load stays controlled and safety-led
- Prototype by sensory performance - not ingredient count

**Actual sensory depends on grade, ratio, viscosity and total formulation - this is a direction, not a final formula.*

Competitor Formula Architecture - What the Leaders Are Doing

The strongest premium oils often achieve a lighter feel by separating “marketing hero ingredients” from the actual sensory base.

Benchmark	What leads the formula	Hero treatment story	Sensory / use model
Mielle Light	Grapeseed, soybean, almond, castor, jojoba	Rosemary + mint + biotin + multi-botanical scalp care	Weightless moisture; scalp treatment + daily use
Olaplex No.7	Silicones + isohexadecane + isoalkane + coco-caprylate	Bond-building molecule + shine / breakage / heat protection	2-3 drops; wet or dry hair; ultra-light styling oil
Gisou	Dimethicone + dimethiconol + trisiloxane	Honey + almond/coconut/argan/passionfruit oils	1-3 drops; mid-lengths to ends; shine/frizz focus
Kérastase Elixir Ultime	Lightweight salon-oil architecture	Wild camellia + professional shine/heat/frizz story	Multi-use beautifying oil; premium fragrance + finish

KEY TAKEAWAY **A product can be marketed as an “oil” while using a light-spreading sensory base. That is the main lesson JL COLLECTION should borrow.**

Sources: Mielle official Rosemary Mint Light; OLAPLEX No.7 official; Gisou Honey Infused Hair Oil official; Kérastase Elixir Ultime official (accessed Sep 2026).

JL COLLECTION vs. Competitors - The Difference We Can Own

We should not compete as “another shine oil.” The strongest territory is a light botanical scalp + hair treatment.

	Mielle Light Botanical scalp oil	Olaplex No.7 Repair styling oil	Gisou Luxury shine oil	JL COLLECTION Botanical treatment oil
Scalp treatment depth	●●●●●	●○○○○	●○○○○	●●●●●
Herbal / botanical story	●●●●●	●○○○○	●●●○○	●●●●●
Ultra-light finish	●●●●○	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●●●
Hair-length shine / polish	●●●○○	●●●●●	●●●●●	●●●●○
South Asian ingredient relevance	●○○○○	●○○○○	●●○○○	●●●●●
Science / proof language	●●●○○	●●●●●	●●●●○	●●●○○

OWNABLE IDEA: “LIGHT BOTANICAL TREATMENT”

Analytical comparison based on official product positioning and ingredient architecture; JL scores are recommended target state, not measured performance.

Recommended Formula Architecture for a Lighter JL Oil

Keep the signature botanicals, but redesign the vehicle around spreadability, absorption and low residue.

1. LIGHTWEIGHT BASE - dominant sensory engine

Examples for discussion: grapeseed / jojoba + dry-touch emollient system (natural-origin or silicone route, depending brand brief).

2. HERITAGE NOURISHING OILS - supporting, not dominant

Almond + coconut + olive + mustard retained for story and conditioning, but balanced to avoid drag and residue.

3. BOTANICAL TREATMENT COMPLEX

Rosemary + Arnica + Amla + Shikakai + Reetha as controlled, standardized, oil-compatible extracts/infusions.

4. REVIEW / GO-NO-GO ACTIVES

Jaborandi + Thuja: keep only if safety assessor, supplier documentation and target-market regulation support inclusion.

This architecture intentionally separates “what makes it feel light” from “what makes the treatment story unique.”

Two Development Routes - Choose the Brand Philosophy

Both routes can feel light. The choice affects claims, cost, ingredient perception and competitor set.

ROUTE A

Botanical / Natural-Origin Light Oil

- Lead with light seed oils / jojoba-type materials
- Use natural-origin dry-touch emollients if needed
- Preserve “botanical treatment” credibility
- Closer strategic benchmark: Mielle Light
- **Best when: natural botanical story is the primary brand promise.**
  May need more work to match silicone-serum slip

ROUTE B

Premium Serum-Oil Hybrid

- Use high-slip light emollients / silicones if allowed
- Botanical oils become the treatment/brand layer
- Easier to achieve instant non-greasy polish
- Closer benchmarks: Olaplex, Gisou, Kérastase
- **Best when: luxury sensory performance is the primary promise.**
  Requires clear stance on “natural” marketing

RECOMMENDATION FOR DISCUSSION: start with Route A+, then add only the minimum technology needed to hit the sensory target.

Proposed Treatment Use Model

A hybrid usage system can make the product more valuable than a traditional pre-shampoo oil.

01

PRE-WASH SCALP TREATMENT

Apply sparingly to scalp, massage gently, leave for a defined treatment window, then shampoo. Primary territory: scalp conditioning + nourishment.

02

LENGTH & BREAKAGE CARE

Work a small amount through dry mid-lengths/ends before wash day or as targeted end care. Primary territory: softness + reduced dry/brittle feel.

03

MICRO-DOSE FINISH

If the final prototype is light enough, use 1-3 drops on lengths for smoothness and satin shine without a greasy look.

Avoid making "overnight use" a hero claim until irritation, transfer, fragrance and scalp-comfort testing support it.

Recommended Treatment & Claim Territory

Build premium value through credible cosmetic outcomes - not medical hair-regrowth language.

STRONG COSMETIC TERRITORY

What JL can aim to prove

- Nourishes and conditions the scalp
- Helps reduce hair breakage from dryness / grooming
- Supports length retention through better conditioning
- Improves softness, smoothness and manageability
- Adds lightweight satin shine
- Helps hair feel healthier and stronger

DO NOT LEAD WITH WITHOUT ROBUST EVIDENCE

High-risk claim territory

- “Regrows hair” / “new hair growth”
- “Stops hair fall” as an absolute claim
- “Treats alopecia” or medical scalp disease
- “Reactivates follicles”
- Drug-like mechanism claims
- Guaranteed timelines without clinical substantiation

Meeting outcome: define 3-4 hero claims that the final prototype will be tested against.

Draft Product Description for Discussion

Working copy to align formulation, packaging and brand language - not final regulatory copy.

JL COLLECTION

Premium Botanical Scalp & Hair Treatment Oil

A lightweight botanical treatment designed to condition the scalp and nourish hair without the heavy, greasy feel of traditional oiling. The formula brings together rosemary and a South Asian botanical complex with carefully balanced nourishing oils to support softer, smoother, healthier-looking hair, help reduce dryness-related breakage and leave a clean satin finish.

SCALP-FIRST | LIGHT FEEL | BOTANICAL COMPLEX | BREAKAGE + SHINE

POSITIONING LINE: “Treatment depth. Lightweight finish.”

Safety & Regulatory Gates Before Finalizing the Formula

Two draft botanicals need special attention, and the entire formula should be validated as a finished cosmetic system.

Jaborandi - GO / NO-GO decision

EU Cosmetics Regulation lists Pilocarpus jaborandi and its galenical preparations among prohibited substances. This creates an export-readiness issue and warrants specialist review even if Pakistan is the first market.

Thuja - material specification matters

Thuja essential-oil materials can be thujone-rich. Use only with supplier composition data and a qualified safety assessment; do not treat “Thuja” as a generic botanical add-on.

Botanical extracts - standardize the inputs

Define plant part, extraction method, solvent/carrier, INCI name, assay/specification, allergens and microbiological/contaminant limits for every botanical raw material.

Finished product - validate the system

Stability, oxidation, packaging compatibility, scalp tolerance/patch testing, fragrance/allergen review and consumer sensory testing should precede scale-up and claims.

This deck recommends a product direction - not a safe-use concentration or manufacturing recipe. Final percentages should be set by the formulator/safety assessor after raw-material documentation is reviewed.

Sources: EU Cosmetics Regulation (EC) No 1223/2009, Annex II; European Commission CosIng; SCCS fragrance-allergen opinion noting thujone-rich Thuja leaf oil materials.

Meeting Decision Sheet

Use this slide to close the discussion with clear directions for the first prototype brief.

A	**Primary format**	Pre-wash treatment / Hybrid treatment + leave-in micro-dose
B	**Sensory benchmark**	Mielle Light / Olaplex-Gisou lightness / In-between
C	**Formula route**	Natural-origin light oil / Premium serum-oil hybrid
D	**Jaborandi**	Keep pending review / Replace / Remove
E	**Thuja**	Keep pending safety spec / Replace / Remove
F	**Hero claims**	Scalp nourishment / Breakage / Length retention / Shine / Smoothness
G	**Prototype test**	Blind sensory vs. Mielle Light + one salon oil benchmark

OUTPUT AFTER MEETING: FORMULATOR BRIEF + PROTOTYPE 01 SENSORY TARGET

Reference Sources

Official brand pages and regulatory sources used for the comparison and safety flags.

01	**Mielle - Rosemary Mint Light Scalp & Hair Strengthening Oil**	mielleorganics.com/products/rosemary-mint-light-scalp-hair-strengthening-oil	Lightweight formula, ingredient list, use model.
02	**Mielle - Rosemary Mint Scalp & Hair Strengthening Oil**	mielleorganics.com/products/rosemary-mint-oil	Original oil ingredient list and treatment directions.
03	**OLAPLEX - No.7 Bonding Oil**	olaplex.com/products/olaplex-n-7-bonding-oil-30ml	Ingredient list, 2-3 drop usage, lightweight styling positioning.
04	**Gisou - Honey Infused Hair Oil**	gisou.com/products/honey-infused-hair-oil	Ingredient list, usage, best-seller positioning and sensory claims.
05	**Kérastase - Elixir Ultime Refillable Hydrating Hair Oil**	kerastase-usa.com/collections/elixir-ultime	Wild Camellia, lightweight salon-oil positioning and benefits.
06	**European Commission - Regulation (EC) No 1223/2009**	health.ec.europa.eu/system/files/2016-11/cosmetic_1223_2009_regulation_en_0.pdf	Annex II listing Pilocarpus jaborandi / galenical preparations.
07	**European Commission - CosIng / SCCS**	ec.europa.eu/growth/tools-databases/cosing/ | health.ec.europa.eu/scientific-committees	Ingredient identity references and Thuja/thujone safety context.